BURKE BURNS & PINELLI, LTD.
ATTORNEYS AT LAW
SUITE 4300
THREE FIRST NATIONAL PLAZA
CHICAGO, ILLINOIS 60602-4229

EDWARD J. BURKE
MARY PATRICIA BURNS
VINCENT D. PINELLI
MARY ANN MURRAY
STEPHEN F. WELCOME
ELLEN B. EPSTEIN
DONALD F. HARMON
AMANDA RIPP
ADRIANA R. GABRIEL
BLANCA R. DOMINGUEZ
CHRISTOPHER J. HALES

TELEPHONE
(312) 541-8600

FACSIMILE
(312) 541-8603

January 25, 2008

Illinois Finance Authority
Two Prudential Plaza
180 North Stetson Avenue, Suite 2555
Chicago, Illinois 60601

Amalgamated Bank of Chicago, as Trustee
Chicago, Illinois

Re: $8,490,000 Illinois Finance Authority Sports Facility Revenue Bonds (North Shore Ice Arena Project), Series 2008

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have acted as special counsel to the Illinois Finance Authority (the "Authority") in connection with the issuance and sale by the Authority of $8,490,000 aggregate principal amount of its Sports Facility Revenue Bonds (North Shore Ice Arena Project), Series 2008 (the "Bonds"), pursuant to a Trust Indenture dated as of January 1, 2008 (the "Indenture"), between the Authority and Amalgamated Bank of Chicago, Chicago, Illinois, as trustee (the "Trustee") and a Loan Agreement, dated as of January 1, 2008 (the "Loan Agreement"), by and among the Authority, North Shore Ice Arena, LLC (the "Borrower"), Wilmette Hockey Association, Inc. ("Wilmette Hockey Association"), and Winnetka Hockey Club, Inc. ("Winnetka Hockey Club" and, together with Wilmette Hockey Association, the "Guarantors").

In connection with the issuance of the Bonds, as special counsel to the Authority, we have examined the following:

(i) the Indenture;

(ii) the Loan Agreement;

(iii) a specimen Bond;

(iv) the resolution adopted by the governing body of the Authority on November 13, 2007 (the "Bond Resolution"), as amended and restated by the resolution adopted by the governing body of the Authority on January 15, 2008 (the "Amendatory Bond Resolution" and, together with the Bond Resolution, the "Resolution"), authorizing the issuance, offering and sale of the Bonds under the terms set forth in the Resolution and authorizing the distribution of a Limited Offering Memorandum relating to the Bonds (the "Limited Offering Memorandum");

(v) the Bond Purchase Agreement among the Authority, Oppenheimer & Co. Inc., as Underwriter, the Borrower and the Guarantors, dated January 17, 2008 (the "Purchase Agreement");

(vi) the Tax Exemption Certificate and Agreement dated as of January 25, 2008 (the "Tax Agreement") between the Authority and the Borrower; and

(vii) the Illinois Finance Authority Act, 20 ILCS 3501/801-1, *et seq.*, as amended (the "Act").

In addition, we have examined originals or copies, certified or otherwise identified to our satisfaction, of such other records of the Authority, certificates of officers and representatives of the Authority, and other documents, and have made such investigation of law, as we have deemed necessary or advisable for the purpose of rendering the opinions hereinbelow expressed. We have assumed that the representations and warranties as to factual matters made by the Authority are true and correct. We have also assumed the genuineness and authenticity of all documents submitted to us as originals; the conformity to originals of all documents submitted to us as copies; the authorization and due execution and delivery of the Indenture, the Loan Agreement, the Tax Agreement and the Purchase Agreement (hereinafter, the "Authority Documents"), by any party other than the Authority, when authorization and due execution and delivery are a prerequisite to the effectiveness thereof; and that all Authority Documents are the valid and binding obligations of the other parties thereto.

Revenues from payments by the Borrower under the Loan Agreement and from certain other sources provided for and described in the Indenture are the only sources available for payment of either principal of, or interest on, the Bonds. The Authority is not obligated to pay the principal amount of, or any interest on, the Bonds. Neither the full faith and credit nor the taxing power of the State of Illinois is pledged to the payment of the principal of, or interest on, the Bonds. The Authority has no taxing power with which to provide payment of the principal amount of, or interest on, the Bonds nor does it have the power to commit the faith and credit or the taxing power of the State of Illinois or any political subdivision thereof to payment of the principal amount of, or interest on, the Bonds.

Subject to the foregoing, we are of the opinion that as of the date hereof:

(i) The Authority is a body politic and corporate, duly organized and validly existing under the laws of the State of Illinois and particularly the Act;

(ii) The Authority has all necessary power and authority to (a) execute and deliver the Authority Documents; (b) issue the Bonds in the manner contemplated by the Resolution; and (c) otherwise consummate all of the actions of the Authority contemplated by the Resolution and the Authority Documents;

(iii) At the time of its adoption, the Authority had all necessary power and authority to adopt the Resolution and the Resolution has been duly adopted by the Authority at a meeting duly called and held in accordance with applicable law and the Resolution is in full force and effect and has not been rescinded, amended or modified since its adoption;

(iv) The Bonds have been duly authorized by all necessary action on the part of the Authority, have been duly executed by authorized officers of the Authority and, when authenticated and issued and paid for as provided for in the Indenture, will constitute the legal, valid and binding special and limited obligations of the Authority, enforceable in accordance with their terms, and are entitled to the benefit and security of the Indenture; *provided, however,* that their enforcement may be limited by bankruptcy, insolvency, reorganization, moratorium, and other similar laws affecting creditors' rights generally, heretofore or hereafter enacted, to the extent constitutionally applicable, and their enforcement may also be subject to the exercise of judicial discretion in appropriate cases;

(v) The Authority has duly authorized the execution and delivery of the Authority Documents;

(vi) The Authority has duly authorized the distribution of the Limited Offering Memorandum;

(vii) To the best of our knowledge, based solely upon certificates of officers of the Authority and inquiry of the General Counsel of the Authority, there is not now pending after service of summons, or threatened, any suit or proceeding against the Authority in any court or before any governmental entity, agency, tribunal or board (a) seeking to restrain or enjoin the issuance or delivery of the Bonds; (b) questioning or affecting the validity of the Bonds or the Authority Documents or any agreement or instrument to which the Authority is a party and which is used or contemplated for use in the consummation of the transactions contemplated therein, or the proceedings or authority under which the Bonds are to be issued; (c) questioning the right of the Authority to execute and deliver the Bonds or any of the Authority Documents; (d) questioning the right of the Authority to secure the Bonds in the manner provided in the Indenture and the Act; or (e)

in any way contesting the creation, organization or existence of the Authority or the title of present members or other officials of the Authority to their respective offices;

(viii) To the best of our knowledge, the authorization, execution and delivery by the Authority of the Bonds and the Authority Documents, and the authorization of the distribution of the Limited Offering Memorandum, and the compliance with the provisions of each of the aforementioned documents by the Authority under the circumstances contemplated therein, do not or will not violate any resolution or ordinance of the Authority or conflict with or constitute, on the part of the Authority, a breach of, or default under, any regulation, order or consent decree of any court or governmental tribunal to which the Authority is subject and will not conflict with or violate, or result in a breach of any of the provisions of, or constitute a default under, any agreement or instrument to which the Authority is a party or by which the Authority or any of its property is bound;

(ix) All consents, approvals, orders or authorizations of any governmental authority, agency or commission having jurisdiction which are required for the execution and delivery by the Authority of the Authority Documents or the Bonds or the consummation by the Authority of the actions contemplated by the foregoing documents have been obtained, *provided, however,* that we express no opinion with respect to any state or federal securities laws or regulations upon the issuance of the Bonds; and

(x) Based upon our participation in the review and preparation of the Limited Offering Memorandum, but without having undertaken to determine independently the accuracy, completeness or fairness of the statements contained in the Limited Offering Memorandum, we are of the view that as of the date of the Limited Offering Memorandum and as of the date hereof, the statements and summaries contained in the Limited Offering Memorandum under the heading "THE ISSUER" are fair and accurate statements or summaries of the matters therein set forth. To the best of our knowledge, based solely upon certificates of officers of the Authority and inquiry of the General Counsel of the Authority, the statements and summaries contained in the Limited Offering Memorandum relating to the Authority under the heading "LITIGATION" are fair and accurate statements or summaries of the matters therein set forth. We have not been asked to express, and are not herein expressing, an opinion with respect to any section of the Limited Offering Memorandum other than the aforementioned sections or with respect to any other information supplied to purchasers of the Bonds.

The foregoing opinions are further subject to the following qualifications:

(i) We are licensed to practice law only in the State of Illinois and we express no opinion concerning any law other than the law of the State of Illinois.

(ii) We express no opinion as to the effect of the compliance or non-compliance by any party other than the Authority with any state or federal laws or regulations applicable because of the

legal or regulatory status of such party, or because of the nature of the business of such party or because of such party's participation in the transactions contemplated in the Indenture or the Loan Agreement.

(iii) We express no opinion with regard to the applicability to or effect on the Authority Documents or the Bonds of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, as amended, and the applicable final, temporary or proposed regulations or revenue rulings issued by the Treasury Department of the Internal Revenue Service of the United States. In addition, we express no opinion as to the state or federal tax treatment to be accorded the sale and purchase of the Bonds or the interest, principal or other payments or deposits made under or on the Indenture, the Loan Agreement or the Bonds.

(iv) The opinions expressed herein are based upon an interpretation of, and are limited to, existing laws, ordinances and regulations, which laws are subject to change at any time by legislation, administrative action or judicial decision.

We render this opinion to the parties named above and it may not be relied upon in any manner by any other person or entity without our prior written consent. This opinion is limited to the matters stated herein and no opinion may be implied or inferred beyond the matters expressly stated. This opinion is given as of the date hereof and we assume no obligation to advise of changes that may hereafter be brought to our attention.

Very truly yours,

Burke Burns & Pinelli, Ltd.

BURKE BURNS & PINELLI, LTD.